

THE RIGHT COURSE

Companies consider Tier 1 colleges in India such as IITs, BITS, NITs, etc., as a good source of qualified engineers. However, candidates from regional colleges such as VJTI or Manipal Institute are also considered, provided these students can opt for a course in VLSI design. Companies look for students at undergraduate and masters levels in computer science and electronics domains with a consistently high GPA. Here's a list of some of the top places that offer courses in VLSI Design and allied fields, as recommended by VLSI chip design companies.

- **CDAC, Hyderabad:** Certificate course in Digital and Analog VLSI Design (CDAD)
- **Sandeepani School of VLSI Design, Bangalore & Hyderabad:** Post-graduate diploma in VLSI Design
- **Veda IIT, Hyderabad:** MS and Diploma in VLSI and Embedded Systems
- **Cranes Software, Bangalore:** Embedded System certification
- **Vedant Chandigarh, Lucknow:** Course in front-end and back-end design including Analogue & Mixed Signal Design

Talent is sourced by tying up with premier schools in the country, where companies engage in open forums and interviews. Internship is another means. Intel has a very strong internship programme. Hiring engineering students as interns and having them work with their design teams lets students get a first-hand experience of what it's like to work in this industry. At the end, companies take on the better ones as fulltime employees. Intel has been known to take on over 100-150 interns working in different development groups across India.

The intake varies widely from company to company. AMD believes in taking only a few people at a time. This is due to the steep learning curve. When it comes to microprocessor design, it doesn't use large teams. The Athlon design was done with less than 200 people. Therefore, finding the right talent is more important than making up the numbers.

Training

Some reports suggest that while sourcing talent, semiconductor companies find that there's a lack of engineers who can immediately be deployed on a design and that Indian electronics engineers need additional training and skill development. However, many industry insiders we spoke to